

The AI *Starter Kit*

Stop using AI like a search engine. One formula, ten prompts and a cheat sheet that turn it into the assistant you've been told it could be.

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 - 03 Which AI to use — and the cost

- 04 A week with AI, in practice
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Why your AI answers feel generic

Most people type a question into AI the way they'd type a Google search. Short in, generic out. AI isn't a search box — it's closer to a sharp new colleague who knows nothing about you. Brief it like one.

1 Role Who should it act as? "Act as a hiring manager in healthcare."	2 Context What does it need to know? Your situation, audience and constraints.
3 Task Exactly what you want done — one clear job.	4 Format What the answer should look like: length, layout, tone.

THE SEARCH-ENGINE HABIT

~~write a cover letter~~

ROLE · CONTEXT · TASK · FORMAT

Act as a recruiter who has read 10,000 cover letters. I'm applying for a project coordinator role at a hospital; I've spent six years in retail management and I'm good at scheduling and calming upset customers. Write a cover letter that connects my retail experience to this role without apologising for it. Keep it under 250 words, warm but confident, and skip clichés like "I am writing to express my interest."

Four habits that matter more than the perfect prompt

Keep talking.

The first answer is a draft. Reply "shorter," "more specific," "sound more like me." The quality is in the second and third message.

Give it your material.

Paste the job posting, the email thread, your notes. Real material beats description every time.

Let it ask you.

End any prompt with "Ask me questions before you start." It will draw out the context you forgot to give.

Check the facts.

AI can sound certain and still be wrong. Anything that matters — numbers, names, dates, rules — verify it.

Ten prompts worth keeping

Copy them, swap the **[bracketed]** parts for your details, and paste into any AI tool. On a phone, use the link under each one — it copies the prompt in one tap.

01 The "Interview Me First"

ANY TASK

The single biggest upgrade. Instead of guessing, the AI pulls the context out of you.

I want help with **[the task — e.g. planning my kid's birthday / writing a LinkedIn post / fixing my budget]**. Before you give me anything, ask me up to 5 questions, one at a time, that you need answered to do this really well. After my last answer, give me your best version.

Copy it in one tap: anotherrealmgateway.com/kit#p1

02 Explain It Like I'm New

LEARNING

Learn anything — a new job skill, a medical bill, a lease — without feeling dumb.

Explain **[topic]** to me like I'm smart but completely new to it. Use one everyday analogy, then give me the 3 things that actually matter and the 1 mistake beginners make. Finish with a 3-question quiz so I know I've got it.

Copy it in one tap: anotherrealmgateway.com/kit#p2

03 The Resume Bullet Upgrade

JOB SEARCH

Turns "responsible for" duties into results a hiring manager actually notices.

Act as a hiring manager for **[target job title]**. Here are bullets from my resume: **[paste bullets]**. Rewrite each one to lead with a strong verb and show a result. Where a number would help and I haven't given one, ask me for it — don't invent it. Show before and after side by side.

Copy it in one tap: anotherrealmgateway.com/kit#p3

Why "don't invent it" matters: AI will happily make up impressive numbers. Recruiters ask about them in interviews.

04 The Job Posting Decoder

JOB SEARCH

See what a posting is really asking for — and exactly where you match.

Here's a job posting: **[paste posting]**. And here's my resume: **[paste resume]**. Give me: (1) the 5 things this employer cares about most, in plain English, (2) where I'm a strong match, with proof from my resume, (3) my honest gaps and how I could address each one in my application.

Copy it in one tap: anotherrealmgateway.com/kit#p4

05 The Practice Interviewer

JOB SEARCH

Rehearse out loud with a patient interviewer who gives real feedback.

Act as an interviewer for a **[job title]** role at a **[type of company]**. Ask me one interview question at a time — mix of behavioral and role-specific. After each answer, tell me what worked, what was weak, and show me a stronger version using my own details. Don't move to the next question until I say "next."

Copy it in one tap: anotherrealmgateway.com/kit#p5

Try it with voice mode on your phone. Answering out loud is much closer to the real thing.

06 The Hard Email

EVERYDAY WORK

For the message you've been putting off: asking for a raise, pushing back, saying no.

Help me write an email to **[who — e.g. my manager / a landlord / a client]**. Situation: **[what happened]**. What I want: **[the outcome]**. Give me 2 versions — one direct, one softer — each under 150 words. Sound like a calm, confident person, not a corporate robot.

Copy it in one tap: anotherrealmgateway.com/kit#p6

07 Mess to Action List

EVERYDAY WORK

Meeting notes, voice memos, a chaotic group chat — turned into who does what by when.

Below are my messy notes from **[a meeting / a phone call / my brain dump]**. Turn them into: (1) a 3-sentence summary, (2) a list of action items with who owns each and any deadline mentioned, (3) open questions nobody answered. If something's unclear, flag it instead of guessing. Notes: **[paste]**

Copy it in one tap: anotherrealmgateway.com/kit#p7

08 Plan My Week (For Real)

LIFE

A schedule built around your actual energy and obligations, not an ideal robot's.

Help me plan next week. Fixed commitments: **[work hours, kids' pickups, appointments]**. Things I need to get done: **[list]**. I have the most energy **[mornings / evenings]**. Build a realistic day-by-day plan with buffer time, put the hardest task where my energy is highest, and tell me what to drop if the week goes sideways.

Copy it in one tap: anotherrealmgateway.com/kit#p8

09 The Decision Helper

LIFE

Stuck between options? Get the angles you haven't considered — without it deciding for you.

I'm deciding between **[option A]** and **[option B]**. What matters most to me: **[e.g. money, time with family, stability]**. Lay out the pros, cons, and hidden costs of each, then tell me what would have to be true for each option to be the right call. Ask me anything you need to know. Don't pick for me — help me see it clearly.

Copy it in one tap: anotherrealmgateway.com/kit#p9

10 The Honest Critic

ANY TASK

AI is polite by default. This makes it tell you what's actually wrong — then fix it.

Here's something I wrote: **[paste — resume, post, email, essay]**. Its goal is **[what it needs to do]**. Be a tough but fair editor: list the 3 biggest problems in order of importance, explain why each one hurts, then give me a revised version that fixes them. Don't soften the feedback.

Copy it in one tap: anotherrealmgateway.com/kit#p10

STACK THEM

The real power move is chaining: **#04** to decode a job posting, **#03** to rewrite your bullets for it, **#10** to critique the result, then **#05** to rehearse the interview. An afternoon's work that used to take a week.

YOUR FIRST TEN MINUTES

Don't read all ten. Do one.

1. Open whichever AI you already have — the free version is fine.
2. Paste **Prompt #01** and fill it in with something real from your week.
3. Answer its questions honestly. Short answers are fine.
4. When the result comes back, reply once with a fix-it line from the cheat sheet.
5. Compare it with what a one-line question would have given you. That gap is the whole kit.

THEN TRY THIS: SAME PROMPT, TWO AIS

Paste the **exact same prompt** into two different AI tools and read the answers side by side. You'll see immediately which one thinks and writes the way you like — that's your tool. (Page 7 compares the four main ones.)

Which AI should you use?

Start free, pick the one you'll actually open every day, and pay only when you keep hitting the limits. All four are good — they're good at different things.

	ChatGPT	Claude	Gemini	Copilot
MADE BY	OpenAI	Anthropic	Google	Microsoft
BEST AT	All-rounder; images; voice conversations	Writing that sounds human; long documents; careful reasoning	Anything inside Gmail, Docs and Google search	Word, Excel, Outlook and Teams users
FREE PLAN	Unlimited everyday text chat; images, uploads and advanced tools capped	Solid free tier with a message cap that resets every few hours	Free tier with limits that reset every few hours	Free Copilot chat
CHEAPEST UPGRADE	Go · \$8/mo	Pro · \$20/mo (\$17/mo billed yearly)	AI Plus · \$4.99/mo	Microsoft 365 plans with Copilot
MAIN PAID PLAN	Plus · \$20/mo	Pro · \$20/mo	AI Pro · \$19.99/mo	Varies by Microsoft 365 plan
WATCH OUT FOR	Ads on the free and Go tiers in the US	Free cap arrives quickly on heavy days	Best features tied to your Google account	Most useful only if you live in Office

Job hunting?

Claude or ChatGPT for resumes and cover letters. Keep whichever sounds more like you.

Live in Gmail?

Gemini — it's already where your email and documents are.

Office job on Microsoft?

Copilot is probably already in your work tools. Check before paying for anything.

Just starting?

ChatGPT's free plan. Unlimited everyday chat means you can practise without watching a counter.

Prices and limits as of September 2026. AI companies change plans often, so check the official pricing page before you pay. Never paste passwords, account numbers or your Social Security number into any AI tool, and check your settings for whether your chats are used to train the model.

One ordinary week, about five hours back

Meet Dana — an example, not a real person, built from the tasks people say eat their week. She manages a small office, is quietly job hunting and has two kids. Nothing fancy: just the prompts in this kit.

Monday — the inbox

A vendor got an order wrong and she’s been avoiding the reply. Prompt #06 gives her a firm, polite email in two minutes instead of twenty minutes of writing and deleting.

Tuesday — the meeting

She pastes her scribbled notes into Prompt #07. Action items with owners go out before she’s left her desk.

Wednesday — the job she wants

A posting she likes goes up. Prompt #04 shows she matches four of five priorities; Prompt #03 rewrites her bullets to prove it. Application done in one lunch break.

Thursday — the interview

She gets a call-back. Twenty minutes of Prompt #05 in the car (voice mode, parked) and she walks in having answered the hard questions once already.

Sunday — the week ahead

Prompt #08 turns practice, a dentist appointment and two deadlines into a plan she can actually follow.

Time saved (estimates)

Hard emails, all week	~1 hr
Meeting follow-ups	~45 min
Tailoring one application	~1.5 hrs
Interview preparation	~1 hr
Weekly planning	~30 min
Total	~4.75 hrs

That isn’t a productivity hack. It’s an evening with her kids, every week.

Your number will differ. The point is that the savings come from ordinary tasks, not from becoming a “tech person.”

Print this. Keep it by your screen.

The formula

Role — “Act as a...” · **Context** — who, what, why, constraints · **Task** — one clear job · **Format** — length, layout, tone

Power phrases

“Ask me questions first.” Draws out missing context

“Give me three options.” Stops you settling for draft one

“Show before and after.” See exactly what changed

“Explain your reasoning.” Catch bad logic early

“Don’t invent facts — ask me.” Stops made-up numbers

“Sound like a real person.” Removes corporate-speak

Fix-it replies

Too long? “Cut this in half. Keep the best parts.”

Too generic? “Make it specific to my situation.”

Too stiff? “Rewrite it like I’m talking to a friend.”

Too polite? “Be blunt. What’s actually wrong?”

Off track? “Start over. Here’s what I really need...”

Nearly right? “Keep everything, just change ____.”

Never paste in

Passwords or login codes

Social Security, bank or card numbers

Your employer’s confidential information

Other people’s private details

Always double-check

Numbers, dates and statistics

Names, titles and quotes

Anything legal, medical or financial

Links and sources — ask for them, then open them

The one rule

Treat the first answer as a **draft**, not a verdict. The difference between people who say “AI is overrated” and people who say “AI saves me hours” is usually one follow-up message.

You have the foundation. Here's where it leads.

Everything in this kit is free and stays free. If you're job hunting and want the complete system, that's what comes next.

Free

YOU ARE HERE

The AI Starter Kit

The formula, ten prompts, the tool guide and the cheat sheet — plus short emails with one new technique at a time.

\$27

30-DAY
PLAYBOOK

How to Get Hired Using AI (*Without Getting Rejected*)

A day-by-day plan for your resume, LinkedIn, applications, networking and interview preparation — with the prompts for every step.

COMING SOON

\$147

COACH +
BLUEPRINT

Gateway Interview Coach + Blueprint

A personalised AI interview coach for your target role, plus the walkthrough to build it yourself — so you keep the skill, not just the tool.

COMING SOON

STAY CLOSE

Follow [@argateway](#) on TikTok for a new prompt, walkthrough or tool comparison every day.
Found this useful? Send it to one person who's still using AI like a search engine.